

WELCOME · WANSTEAD FELLAS

P526 · INDUCTION

THE NEW-JOINER THREE-PAGER · 26 AUG 2026

Welcome in. You've joined **Wanstead Fellas** — a Thursday-night 8-a-side football group in E11 that's been running since 2020 and grown to ~70 fellas across every age from Under-20s to 50+. What follows is everything you need to know in three pages. Read once, come Thursday.

A Wanstead Fellas Thursday

Where: Eton Manor, Ruckholt Rd, Leyton E10. Astroturf pitches at the bottom.

When: Every Thursday, 21:00–22:00 kick-off — arrive 20:45 at the latest.

Format: Usually a **four-team 8v8 round-robin** — six 20-minute games. Occasionally a straight 10v10 or a tournament. Always social, always competitive.

Bring: Boots or astro trainers. Something dark and something light — teams are bibs vs skins, decided per game. Water.

WHAT A TYPICAL NIGHT LOOKS LIKE

1. **Teams are already published** before you arrive — check the **Teams** tab in the app on the way over.
2. **You'll play three short games** — every team plays every other team, ~20 mins each. Rolling subs.
3. **Awards are voted** the next morning in-app — Man of the Match, Dick of the Day, sometimes a themed award (e.g. "Peak dad-strength").
4. **Post-match pub** is optional but recommended. The **Fellowship Inn** or wherever the group heads.

 **Introduce yourself.** If it's your first night, find **Paul Barham** (organiser) at pitch-side and say hello. He'll point out who's who and make sure you know the drill. Everyone else will make themselves known — nobody stays a stranger past the first game.

Under-the-radar rules

Three unwritten ones that the app can't enforce:

- **Play through niggles when you can** — but log real injuries in the app so admin can plan (see p3).
- **Don't be a cunt.** There's literally a fine for this. It's called Cuntiness.
- **Buy your round.** On pitch and off it.



The app — 60-second orientation

The whole club runs off wanstead-fellas.vercel.app. It's a free web app — no App Store, no download. Open the URL, hit "Add to Home Screen" (iPhone Safari) or "Install" (Android Chrome) and you're set. It'll behave like a proper app after that.

FIRST FIVE MINUTES

1. Sign up with your email + password.
2. Go to [Profile](#) — add a photo, name, age band, preferred position (GK / DEF / MID / ATT), preferred foot, favourite club. Two minutes.
3. **Enable notifications** — the one-tap toggle on Profile. This is how you'll hear about teams being published, match reports going live, and dropouts.
4. Go to [Tonight](#) and hit "**Mark Me In**" for the next game. Do this **before Wednesday 10pm**.
5. Have a poke around the other tabs — [Cards](#), [History](#), [Predictor](#). All will make more sense after your first Thursday.

THE TABS, IN ONE LINE EACH



Tonight

Sign up. See who else is in. Countdown to kick-off. Weather. The injury list.



Teams

Published after Wednesday 10pm. Your team is highlighted; captains and bibs shown.



Match

Latest result, group table, scorers, match report, awards ballot.



Stats

Season leaderboards — top scorers, MOTM count, appearances, clean sheets.



Predictor

Free-to-play — pick the score of a weekly PL/ Championship game (Match of the Week) or fill in a full-season prediction card. Bragging rights only.

... More ·

then [Cards](#), [History](#), [Help](#), [Feedback](#)

Your player card is under [Cards](#). Past match reports under [History](#). Stuck? [Help](#) articles + a [Feedback](#) tab straight to admin.

The two things that trip new joiners up: (1) [Notifications not enabled](#) — you'll miss the "teams are ready" ping and the match report drop. Fix it once on Profile. (2) [Not adding a photo](#) — cards look drab, and the group can't put a face to your name. Takes 5 seconds.

Costs and player tiers

Three tiers, priority in this order when the game oversubscribes (max 32/night):

SUB

£95 / season

Full season paid up front.
Guaranteed spot every week. Most regular players are on this.

WTP★

£5 / game

Long-standing "Wait To Play" players with priority — bumped up ahead of standard WTP when spots are tight.

WTP

£5 / game

Pay-as-you-play. Fill remaining spots on a first-come basis. Most new joiners start here.

Fees are tracked in-app under [Profile → My Finances](#). Pay by bank transfer (details are on the Finances page). Grace period is 2 weeks past a match — beyond that, unpaid balances block future sign-ups until settled.

Sign-up rules & fines

Sign up: Tonight tab → [Mark Me In](#). **Deadline: Wednesday 10pm.** Teams get auto-balanced and published minutes later.

£2

LATE

£2

DROPOUT AFTER WED
10PM

£3

LOST BALL

£5

CUNTINESS

Late = arriving after kick-off. Dropout is waived if you find your own replacement before Thursday. Cuntiness is the group's catch-all for being a moaner, playing dirty, or wilfully spoiling the vibe — the committee has ruled it a fineable offence and, on rare occasions, the committee is right.

Awards, injury list & the rest

 **Awards.** After every match: **Man of the Match** (best on the pitch) and **Dick of the Day** (least — usually a spectacular own-goal, air-kick or full-blown meltdown). Occasional themed award set by admin (Kevin Keegan tribute, Italian football, etc.). Voting closes 10am Friday; winners auto-announced.

 **Injury list.** Picked up a knock? Profile → [Mark myself injured](#) → pick a type + when you're back. The group sees a " On the injury list" strip on the Tonight tab so nobody chases you for numbers. Play through niggles if you can — the app [warns](#) if you sign up while marked injured, but doesn't block.

 **WhatsApp vs the app.** WhatsApp for banter and last-minute shouts. App for anything with a deadline (sign-ups, votes, fines, predictor). Admin lives in the app; the group chat is the pub.

Any questions: Feedback tab in the app goes straight to Paul. Category "General" if you're not sure. Zero-friction, no reply expected within any particular window — but it never goes unread.



SEE YOU THURSDAY · PITCH AT 21:00 · WELCOME TO THE FELLAS